On January 27, 1975, the United States Senate Select Committee to Study Governmental Operations with Respect to Intelligence Activities, aka the Church Committee, was founded with a vote of 82 to 4 and Frank Church chaired the committee. The Committee revealed the FBI, CIA, and NSA spying on its own citizens. These secret agencies tried to assassinate leaders from foreign countries, spy on certain anti-war persons such as Martin Luther King Jr., and monitor the watch-listed citizens to know what they do.

The main purpose of the committee is to investigate these agencies and write reports. At that time, those agencies claimed that they monitored those people for national security but, there is a big difference between national security and privacy. They tracked everything the person did. The president of the committee and its vice president met with President Gerald Ford and as a result, the white house cooperated with the committee's investigation.

The FBI was founded in 1908 and J. Edgar Hoover became the director in 1924. He believed that King had a connection with communists. Therefore, the agency began spying on him since 1955. Later, the FBI sent unknown messages to King Jr., and on November 21, 1964, King received a letter of suggestion to suicide. There are also blackmail packages the agency sent to King. This is also known as COINTELPRO which the FBI did illegal things against these anti-war activists.

The committee also reported Project MKUltra, which was shown publicly in 1975. This project revealed that the CIA has been using certain drugs to make confessions to whom they consider guilty for national security. The process had started during World War II by Nazis and an American historian believed that the CIA had keep continuing the project alive. Later in 1947, the US Navy was found to be using lysergic acid diethylamide for the same reason as the CIA had been using it.

The Church Committee also revealed that NSA monitoring people on “watchlist” via telecommunications. The report is known as Project MINARET. The cooperation of NSA, FBI, and CIA worked to investigate their own citizens, Americans, which broke these individuals’ privacy. During those days, 1,650 watch-listed US citizens were being monitored and most of them were the Senators. There is a statement by Wikipedia that “the NSA had issued over 3,900 reports on the watch-listed Americans” meaning these Americans were under monitor for everything they so just because they were anti-war activists. Later, the chairman of the Church Committee, Frank Church was also included in the list, and in 1975, the committee revealed this report.

Project SHAMROCK is also part of project MINARET, which monitors people’s activities in 150,000 messages being printed by the NSA each month. The national security armed forces gave permission to the NSA to check and monitor these activities. This project was also found by the Church Committee.